



TIPS & TRICKS



Generating a random password

Today, it is very important to use secure and random passwords for various accounts.

The `pwgen` command on the Linux terminal generates passwords that are designed to be easily memorised by humans, while being as secure as possible.

```
$ pwgen -1 -s
```

This command generates a single secure password. If we need many passwords, we can skip the `-1` option.



Note: If `pwgen` is not installed, you can install it by using your Linux package manager.

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A script to check for a live host in networks

We often come across situations in which we need to check for a live host/computer in the network. Here is a script that will do the job for you. Open a text editor and create a script as `live-check.sh` with the following contents:

```
#!/bin/bash
for((i=1;i<255;i++))
do
##enter your network ip and redirect it to any text-file##

ping 192.168.1.$i -c1 | grep "bytes from" | cut -d "" -f4
|cut -d ":" -f1 >> ip_scan.txt

done
```

Run the script using the following command and wait for the scan to complete.

```
$sh live-check.sh
```

Once the scan is complete you can check the `ip_scan.txt` file to see the live hosts.

—Pulkit Maheshwari,
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Using `awk` along with the `ssh` command

Many users have an issue when executing the `awk` command with `ssh` and get the following error:

```
#ssh server149.example.com "uname -a | awk '{print $2}'"

awk: cmd. line:1: {print $2}
awk: cmd. line:1:      ^ syntax error
bash: -c: line 0: unexpected EOF while looking for matching
`}'
bash: -c: line 1: syntax error: unexpected end of file
```

This error is due to `awk` considering `$2` of the local system and not the remote system.

To resolve this issue, you can use the `awk` command as shown below:

```
ssh server149.example.com "uname -a | awk '{print \$2}'"
```

This will use the `$2` value of the remote computer and you will get the expected output.

—Ravikant Tyagi,
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Tracking a file in Linux

If you have one important file named `/root/mydata.txt` and need to keep track of who has used it, when it was used and by which program or command, then you can monitor it using the following commands:

```
[root@ns1 ~]# auditctl -w /root/mydata.txt -k "myfile"
```

This command will start monitoring the activity on the file:

```
[root@ns1 ~]# ausearch --key "myfile" --raw | aureport --file
```

This is how you can audit files and get the required details about who used a file and when.

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